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Bank, table

1.6.4 Bank, table

References:

Greek τράπεζα (trapeza) MAT 21:12, MRK 11:15, LUK 19:23, JHN 2:15

Description:

Moneychanger or banker at a table (O.Mustafin, CC0, via Wikimedia Commons)A small table was used by people for conducting money transactions. This was most likely a table at which someone could sit, not a low table where people reclined to eat (see 5.7 Table for eating<REALIA:5.7>).

Translation:

When Jesus confronted the moneychangers in the Temple (MAT 21:12; MRK 11:15; JHN 2:15), he literally overturned the tables where they were transacting business. Just as the English word "bank" comes from a word for table or "bench," so also in Greek the word *trapeza* came to mean a place for financial dealings. In LUK 19:23 the master asks the servant why he had not put the money "on a table." Some translations have "in[to] the bank" (RSV, GNT), while others say "on deposit" (NIV, REB).